THE
Student Shelf

Terms and Policies

Effective 11/1/2026 · The Student Shelf beta · Run by Tucker Lindley · Questions: tlindley1@babson.edu

Terms of Use

Effective 11/1/2026. By creating an account or using The Student Shelf ("the Shelf," "we," "us"), you agree to these Terms, our Privacy Policy, Community Guidelines, Rental and Damage Policy, and Safety and Meetup Guidelines. If you don't agree, don't use the Shelf. The Shelf is run by Tucker Lindley.

1. The Shelf is a beta

The Shelf is an early version. Features may change, break, or be removed, and we may reset or delete test data. We'll try to give notice before major changes.

2. Who can join

- You must be a current Babson College student with an active @babson.edu email address.
- You must be at least 18 years old.
- One account per person. Give your real name and class year, and keep them accurate.
- You're responsible for everything done through your account. Don't share your login or sign-in codes.

3. We connect students; we aren't part of the deal

The Shelf is a place for students to list, find, and arrange trades and rentals with each other. We don't own, inspect, store, or deliver items. We aren't a buyer, seller, lender, renter, agent, or broker in any transaction. We don't guarantee that any item is as described, safe, legal, or delivered, or that any student will show up or pay. Every trade is an agreement between the students involved.

4. Listings and Wanted requests

- Only list items you own or have the right to sell or rent.
- Describe items honestly, including flaws, and use photos of the actual item.
- Follow the Community Guidelines and Prohibited Items list.
- Prices, weights, and "fair price" suggestions shown in the app are estimates, not appraisals or promises.
- We may edit, hide, or remove any listing or request at any time.

5. Meetups and handoff codes

Trades happen in person on campus. When a pickup is confirmed, the buyer or renter gets a 4-digit handoff code. Share it only when you have the item in hand; entering it confirms the handoff. Codes lock after five wrong tries. Follow the Safety and Meetup Guidelines.

6. Payments during the beta

The Shelf doesn't process payments during the beta. Students pay each other directly, by cash or a payment app they choose. We aren't responsible for payments, refunds, or chargebacks between students. Using the Shelf is free during the beta. If we add in-app payments, deposits, fees, or protection plans later, we'll show the terms and prices before you agree to them, and payments will be handled by a third-party processor.

7. Rentals

Rentals follow the Rental and Damage Policy. During the beta, any "protection plan" choice in the app only tells us what you'd want. It provides no coverage, and no one is charged for it.

8. What you can't do

- Break any law or Babson policy, or list prohibited items
- Harass, threaten, discriminate against, or impersonate anyone
- Post false, misleading, or duplicate listings, or fake reviews or reports
- Spam, scrape, or collect other students' information
- Buy items in bulk to flip them for profit during the beta

- Try to break, overload, or get around the Shelf's security, including sign-in and handoff codes
- Create an account for someone else or after we've removed yours

9. Your content

You keep ownership of the listings, photos, and messages you post. You give us permission to store, display, and resize them to run the Shelf, and to show listings to other signed-in students. You confirm you have the right to post them. If you send us feedback, we can use it without owing you anything.

10. Impact numbers

Pounds "rehomed" and similar figures are estimates based on item type. They're for motivation and reporting, not verified measurements.

11. Reports, suspension, and removal

You can report listings and conversations in the app. We may warn you, remove content, limit features, or suspend or close your account if you break these Terms or put others at risk. Where someone may be in danger, we may contact Babson Public Safety or police. You can close your account at any time.

12. Disputes between students

If a trade goes wrong, work it out with the other student first. We may help communicate, but we aren't required to resolve disputes and we don't pay claims. To the extent the law allows, you release the Shelf and Tucker Lindley from claims arising from disputes with other students.

13. No warranties

The Shelf is provided "as is" and "as available." To the extent the law allows, we disclaim all warranties, including merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose, and non-infringement. We don't promise the Shelf will be uninterrupted, secure, or error-free.

14. Limit on our liability

To the extent the law allows, the Shelf and Tucker Lindley aren't liable for indirect, incidental, special, consequential, or punitive damages, or for lost items, money, or data. Our total liability for any claim related to the Shelf is limited to the greater of $100 or the amount you paid us in the 12 months before the claim. Some places don't allow these limits, so they may not fully apply to you.

15. Indemnity

You agree to cover the Shelf and Tucker Lindley for claims, losses, and reasonable legal costs that come from your listings, your trades or rentals, your conduct, or your breaking these Terms.

16. Disputes with us and governing law

Contact us first at tlindley1@babson.edu and we'll try to resolve it informally within 30 days. If we can't, either side may bring a claim in small claims court or in the state or federal courts located in Massachusetts. Massachusetts law governs these Terms.

17. Not affiliated with Babson

The Shelf is an independent student project. It isn't owned, operated, or endorsed by Babson College.

18. Changes

We may update these Terms. If a change is significant, we'll notify you in the app or by email before it takes effect. Continuing to use the Shelf after that means you accept the new Terms.

19. Contact

Questions: tlindley1@babson.edu

Privacy Policy

Effective 11/1/2026. We collect only what the Shelf needs to work, we never sell your data, and your conversations are visible only to you and the other student in them.

What we collect

- **Account:** your @babson.edu email, name, and class year.
- **What you post:** listings, photos, prices, Wanted requests, and reports you file.
- **Activity:** conversations and messages, pickup times and spots, rental dates, handoff codes, completed trades, and the counts and estimated weights that come from them.
- **Technical:** basic logs our hosting and database providers keep automatically, such as IP address, browser type, and error reports. We don't use advertising trackers.

Who can see what

Information	Who sees it
Name, class year, handoff count, pounds rehomed	Signed-in Babson students
Listings, photos, Wanted requests	Signed-in Babson students
Your email address	Only you and the Shelf's operators
Conversations and messages	Only the two students in the conversation
Your handoff code	Only you, until you show it at pickup
Reports you file	You and the Shelf's operators

The Shelf's operators can't read your conversations through the app. If you report a conversation, we see the report and anything you include in it.

How we use it

- To run the Shelf: sign you in, show listings, deliver messages, and confirm handoffs

- To keep it safe: verify you're a Babson student, review reports, and enforce our rules
- To improve it: count usage and completed trades, and calculate campus totals
- To contact you about your account, security, or changes to these policies

We may share campus-wide totals, like pounds rehomed or number of trades, with Babson or in public. Those totals never identify you.

Services we use

Service	What it does	What it handles
Supabase	Database, sign-in, photo storage	Your account, posts, and messages
Netlify	Hosts the website	Basic visit logs
Resend	Sends sign-in codes by email	Your email address
Stripe (later, if we add payments)	Processes payments	Payment details. We would never see your full card number

We share information with others only when the law requires it, or when we believe it's needed to protect someone's safety.

How long we keep it

We keep your information while your account is open. If you delete your account, we delete your profile, listings, photos, and messages within 30 days. Copies in backups are overwritten on the provider's normal schedule. Campus totals that don't identify you stay.

Your choices

- Edit your name and class year in your profile.
- Delete any listing or request.
- Ask us for a copy of your data, a correction, or account deletion at tlindley1@babson.edu. We'll respond within 30 days.

Security

Your data is stored with access rules that limit each student to what they're allowed to see. No system is perfectly secure. Tell us right away at tlindley1@babson.edu if you think your account was misused.

Age

The Shelf is for students 18 and older. If we learn someone under 18 has an account, we'll delete it.

Babson

The Shelf is independent of Babson College. Babson doesn't give us your records. We only confirm that you can receive email at a @babson.edu address.

Changes

If we change how we use your information, we'll update this policy and tell you in the app or by email before the change takes effect.

Contact

Privacy questions or requests: tlindley1@babson.edu

Community Guidelines and Prohibited Items

List honestly, show up when you say you will, and treat every trade like you'll see the other person in Trim tomorrow, because you probably will.

Good to list

Dorm and room items, furniture, electronics, textbooks and course supplies, clothing and accessories, bikes and sports gear, and clothing or gear for rent. Everything must be legal, safe, clean, and yours.

Not allowed

Category	Examples
Alcohol, tobacco, nicotine	Beer, liquor, vapes, cartridges, pouches
Drugs	Illegal drugs, cannabis products, paraphernalia, prescription medication, injectables
Weapons and dangerous items	Firearms and parts, ammunition, knives other than kitchen knives, pepper spray, fireworks, explosives, hazardous chemicals
Items not allowed in residence halls	Check Residence Life's current list (commonly candles, open-flame devices, and certain heaters or appliances)
Stolen or Babson property	Anything you don't own, including dorm furniture, library books, and dining or lab equipment
Counterfeits and recalled items	Fake designer goods, pirated media or software, items under a safety recall
Academic integrity risks	Completed assignments, exams, answer keys, instructor solution manuals, offers to do coursework
Accounts, money, and tickets	Account logins, gift cards, cash equivalents, crypto, event tickets
Personal hygiene items	Used underwear and swimwear, opened cosmetics, used earbud tips, used mattresses
Living things and adult content	Animals, plants that require permits, sexual content or services
Services	Any paid service during the beta (we may add tutoring or moving help later)

If you're not sure an item is allowed, ask at tlindley1@babson.edu before listing it.

How to behave

- **Be honest.** Describe flaws, use your own photos, and price fairly.
- **Be respectful.** No harassment, threats, slurs, discrimination, or unwanted romantic or sexual messages.
- **Be reliable.** Show up on time or cancel in the app as early as you can. Repeated no-shows can get you suspended.
- **Protect the codes.** Share your handoff code only when you have the item in your hands. Never ask someone for theirs early.
- **Keep it to the Shelf's purpose.** No spam, promotions, recruiting, or messaging students about anything other than the trade.
- **Respect privacy.** Don't share other students' messages, photos, or contact details without permission.

Reporting

Use **Report** on any listing or conversation, or email tlindley1@babson.edu. We review reports within 48 hours during the semester. If someone may be in danger, contact Babson Public Safety or call 911 first.

What happens if rules are broken

Depending on how serious it is, we may remove the listing, give a warning, pause your account, or close it permanently. Illegal activity, threats, or safety risks can lead to an immediate ban and a report to Babson or police.

Rental and Damage Policy

During the beta, rentals are agreements between two students: the Shelf doesn't hold money, collect deposits, or cover damage. Agree on the price, deposit, and return date in the chat before pickup, so there's a written record.

How a rental works

1. **Request.** The renter picks a pickup day. Rentals last up to 3 days unless both students agree otherwise in the chat.
2. **Confirm.** The lender accepts or declines. Once accepted, the renter gets a pickup code.
3. **Pick up.** Meet at the listing's campus spot. Both students check the item and take photos. The lender enters the renter's code.
4. **Return.** The renter brings the item back to the same spot by the due date and marks it returned.
5. **Close.** The lender checks the item within 24 hours and confirms it came back fine or reports damage.

Lenders

- List only items you own, that are clean and in the condition shown in your photos.
- State the item's retail value honestly. It sets the suggested deposit and caps what a renter can owe.
- You may ask for a deposit, paid directly to you. The app suggests about half the retail value. Return it within 24 hours of a good-condition return.
- Don't list items worn directly against the skin, like swimwear or underwear.

Renters

- Use the item for its normal purpose. Don't alter, tailor, or lend it to anyone else.
- Follow the care notes. Don't wash or dry-clean it unless the lender agrees.
- Return it on time, in the condition you received it, apart from normal light wear.
- Tell the lender right away if something happens to it.

Late returns

Unless you agree otherwise, a late return costs **$5 per day**, taken from the deposit. After 7 days late, the lender can treat the item as lost.

Damage and loss

These are the defaults when students haven't agreed to something else. The renter never owes more than the retail value stated in the listing.

What happened	What the renter owes the lender
Normal light wear (small creases, a loose thread)	Nothing
Needs professional cleaning (a stain, a strong smell)	The cleaning cost, with a receipt
Repairable damage (a small tear, a broken zipper, a lost button)	The repair cost, with a receipt
Ruined or lost	A fair replacement value: what the item would cost in similar condition, up to the stated retail value

The lender can keep the deposit up to what's owed and must return the rest with an itemized explanation and photos.

Protection plans (coming soon)

Renters may see protection options when booking. **During the beta these provide no coverage, cost nothing, and only tell us what students would want.** If we launch real protection plans, they'll have their own terms, prices, and claims process, and you'll have to agree to them separately.

Disagreements

1. Talk it through in the chat and share photos from pickup and return.
2. If you're stuck, use **Report** on the conversation. We can help both sides communicate and point to this policy, but we don't decide who's right and we don't pay claims.

3. Either student can go to small claims court. Keep your photos and the chat.

Safety and Meetup Guidelines

Meet in a busy public spot on campus, check the item before any money moves, and leave if anything feels off.

Where and when to meet

- Use the pickup spots in the app: Horn Library, Reynolds Campus Center, Trim Dining Hall, Webster Center, or Weissman Foundry.
- Meet when the building is open and busy. Avoid late nights.
- Don't meet in dorm rooms, parking lots, or off campus. For something too big to carry, like a fridge, meet outside the building and bring a friend to help.
- Tell a friend where you're going and who you're meeting.

At the handoff

1. Check that the person matches the name and class year in the app.
2. Inspect the item: turn it on, check sizes, look for damage. For rentals, both take photos.
3. Pay only after you've seen the item and you're happy with it.
4. Show your handoff code last, once the item is in your hands.

Paying safely during the beta

- Pay in person, with cash or a payment app, at the meetup.
- Don't send money before meeting. The only exception is a rental deposit you've agreed to in the chat.
- On payment apps, send only to the person you're meeting, and double-check the username.
- Never pay with gift cards, and never accept an "overpayment" with a request to send the difference back.

Red flags

- Asking to meet off campus, at night, or somewhere private
- Pushing you to pay first, pay extra, or use gift cards

- Asking for your handoff code before you have the item
- A price far below what similar items sell for, or photos that look copied from a store
- Pressure to move the conversation off the Shelf right away

If something goes wrong

- **Danger or an emergency:** call 911, or contact Babson Public Safety.
- **A scam, no-show, or bad behavior:** use **Report** in the app or email tlindley1@babson.edu. Include screenshots.
- **A trade or rental dispute:** follow the steps in the Rental and Damage Policy.

The Student Shelf is an independent student project and isn't owned, operated, or endorsed by Babson College.